Interviews

SVNIT 2024



What:

- Interaction (two or more persons)
- Questions to assess candidate’s suitability
- Specific purpose: recruitment, admission, or promotion.

Why:

- Focus on psychological and sociological aspects

How?

- Planned and pre-arranged
- Two-way Interaction: Interviewee may also ask some growth- opportunity related questions
- Informality: Some degree of informality reduces the tension.

Pre-interview Preparation

- Resume: Memorizing résumé and organizing certificates, call letter, references (preparing an interview file)
- Self-analysis - Strengths/weaknesses
- Analysis of skills - Skills in regard to the company
- Job Analysis
- Subject knowledge and fundamentals
- Examples corroborating skills - STAR (situation, task, action, and result) approach. The STAR approach provides the outline for the answers. Preparing examples saves time.
- Mock Interview

Cntd...

- Knowing the possible types of interview questions:
  i. Experience questions
  ii. Credential questions
  iii. Opinion questions
  iv. Questions with innovative answers
  v. Behavioural questions

- Knowing the prospective employer: Research the organisation, i.e., detailed info. about the organisation
  - Age of the company
  - Services or products
  - Competitors within the industry—both national and international
  - Growth pattern
  - Reputation/where it stands in the industry
  - Divisions and subsidiaries
  - Locations/length of time there
  - Size of organization
  - Sales/assets/earnings
  - Provision for career growth
  - Ongoing projects
  - Mission, culture, and values

Answering Strategies

1. Focus
2. Attentiveness
3. Accuracy
4. Brevity
5. Logical Thinking
6. Clarity
7. Positive Attitude
8. Using body language effectively

Answering Techniques

- Behavioural answering technique
- Compelling story technique
- Personality matching/mirroring technique
- Parroting technique
- Reframing technique
- Abraham Lincoln technique

Skills and attributes most employers look for

- Technical skills
- Analytical skills
- Career objective
- Mental agility
- Communication and Interpersonal skills
- Flexibility/adaptability
- Management/leadership skills
- Creativity
- Positive/can-do attitude, Honesty and integrity
- Determination/steadfastness
- Professionalism

Factors responsible for failure

- Arrogance
- Apathy
- Uninhibited nervousness
- Equivocation
- Lack of concentration
- Lack of crispness
- Lack of social skills
- Lack of firmness
- Inadequate quantitative/qualitative skills

Some Tips

- Be well prepared.
- Brush up your subject and general knowledge.
- Dress appropriately.
- Do not chew gum during the interview.
- Show up fifteen to twenty minutes earlier.
- When you meet the interviewer, greet confidently.
- Stay calm, do not fidget or twiddle your thumb.
- Carry a neat folder containing all relevant documents.
- Speak clearly.



FAQs

- Tell something about yourself.
- What are your career objectives, long-term, short-term goal?
- Tell us something about your interests.
- Why should we hire you?
- Why do you want to join our company?
- Tell something about your work experience.
- Are you a leader or a follower?
- What are your strengths/weaknesses?
- Will you accept a lower position for the time being?
- When can you join us?

